ETON Advanced French Grammar: Specialists

EW 2

Future and conditional tense irregularities

11. **STEM** (the usual stem is the infinitive, with –RE verbs losing the final **e**)

(a) There are around 20 completely irregular stems which must be learnt by heart

AVOIR	j'**AUR**
ÊTRE	je **SER**
ALLER	j'**IR**
S'ASSEOIR	je m'**ASSIÉR**
COURIR	je **COURR**
CUEILLIR	je **CUEILLER**
DEVOIR	je **DEVR**
ENVOYER	j'**ENVERR**
FAIRE	je **FER**
FALLOIR	il **FAUDR**
MOURIR	je **MOURR**
PLEUVOIR	il **PLEUVR**
POUVOIR	je **POURR**
RECEVOIR	je **RECEVR**
SAVOIR	je **SAUR**
TENIR	je **TIENDR**
VALOIR	je **VAUDR**
VENIR	je **VIENDR**
VOIR	je **VERR**
VOULOIR	je **VOUDR**

(b) There are a number of verbs whose stems are slightly irregular in certain forms.

(i) infinitives ending in e + CONSONANT + ER (eg acheTer, geLer)
take a grave accent throughout the future and conditional
j'ach**è**terai, tu ach**è**verais, il g**è**lera, nous ach**è**terons
eg acheter, mener, geler, lever, peser

(ii) a few infinitives ending in –eler and –eter (eg appeler, jeter)
double the final consonant throughout the future and conditional
j'appe**ll**erai, tu je**tt**erais, il s'appe**ll**erait, ils je**tt**eront, nous appe**ll**erons
eg appeler, épeler, jeter, étinceler, renouveler

(iii) infinitives ending in –AYER, -OYER and –UYER (eg essAYER, envOYER, essUYER)
change the **y** to an **i** throughout the future and conditional (in fact it is optional for –AYER verbs)
j'essa**i**erai/essayerai, tu essu**i**eras, il s'ennu**i**era, nous essu**i**erons
eg essayer, ennuyer, employer, nettoyer, payer

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12. Endings: The endings are always:

Future: ai, as, a, ons, ez ont (looks rather like the present tense of **avoir**)

Conditional: ais, ais, ait, ions, iez, aient (exactly the same endings as the **imperfect**)

The Perfect and pluperfect tenses (Compound tenses)

13. (a)

A compound tenses is made up of two parts: the **AUXILIARY** and the **PAST PARTICIPLE**,
unlike simple, one word tenses, like the present, imperfect, and future.
- je SUIS ALLÉ, nous AVONS REGARDÉ

You should also complete the pre-test exercises as part of your EW

(b)

The auxiliary is always AVOIR or ÊTRE. The huge majority of verbs take **avoir** but a very common set of sixteen (and ALL reflexive verbs) , normally take **être**. These **"être verbs"** are:

descendre, rester, arriver, partir, entrer, retourner, sortir
venir, aller, naître
monter, mourir, tomber, rentrer, devenir, revenir (16)

Tip: Laid out as above you get the "registration number" of **DRAPER'S VAN** **MMTRDR16**

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14. **The tense of avoir or être**. By changing the tense of the auxiliary verb, you can form a variety of different tenses, including the perfect tense, and the pluperfect tense.

PERFECT TENSE = auxiliary in **present tense** (j'ai mangé, nous sommes allés)

PLUPERFECT TENSE = auxiliary in **imperfect tense** (j'avais mangé, nous étions allés)

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15. **The past participle**. This is usually formed as follows:
-ER verbs – é (manger – mangé)
-IR verbs – i (finir – fini)
-RE verbs – u (vendre – vendu)

je suis allé, ils ont rendu, elle est montée, nous avons démoli

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16. **Irregular past participles**.

(a) There is a rather long list to learn by heart.

acquérir	*to acquire*	**acquis**
avoir	*to have*	**eu**
être	*to be*	**été**
s'asseoir	*to sit down*	**assis**
battre	*to beat*	**battu**
boire	*to drink*	**bu**
conduire	*to drive*	**conduit**
connaître	*to know*	**connu**
coudre	*to sew*	**cousu**
courir	*to run*	**couru**
(craindre	*to fear*	**craint**
(atteindre	*to reach*	**atteint**
(joindre	*to join*	**joint**
croire	*to believe*	**cru**
croître	*to grow*	**crû**
cueillir	*to gather*	**cueilli**
devoir	*to have to/to owe*	**dû**
dire	*to say/tell*	**dit**
écrire	*to write*	**écrit**
faire	*to do/make*	**fait**

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falloir	*to be necessary*	**fallu**
fuire	*to flee*	**fui**
haïr	*to hate*	**haï**
mettre	*to put (on)*	**mis**
moudre	*to grind*	**moulu**
mourir	*to die*	**mort**
naître	*to be born*	**né**
nuire	*to harm*	**nui**
ouvrir	*to open*	**ouvert**
paraître	*to seem*	**paru**
plaire	*to please*	**plu**
pleuvoir	*to rain*	**plu**
pouvoir	*to be able to*	**pu**
prendre	*to take*	**pris**
(recevoir	*to receive*	**reçu**
(apercevoir	*to notice*	**aperçu**
résoudre	*to resolve*	**résolu**
rire	*to laugh*	**ri**
rompre	*to break*	**rompu**
savoir	*to know*	**su**
suffire	*to be enough*	**suffi**
suivre	*to follow*	**suivi**
se taire	*to shut up*	**tu**
tenir	*to hold*	**tenu**
vaincre	*to conquer*	**vaincu**
valoir	*to be worth*	**valu**
venir	*to come*	**venu**
vêtir	*to clothe*	**vêtu**
vivre	*to live*	**vécu**
voir	*to see*	**vu**
vouloir	*to want*	**voulu**

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